

Figure 3.38 Solenoid

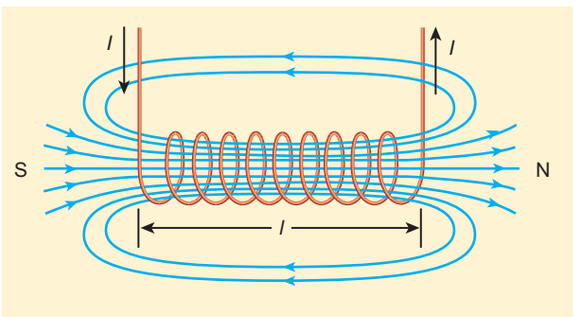


Figure 3.39 Solenoid as a bar magnet

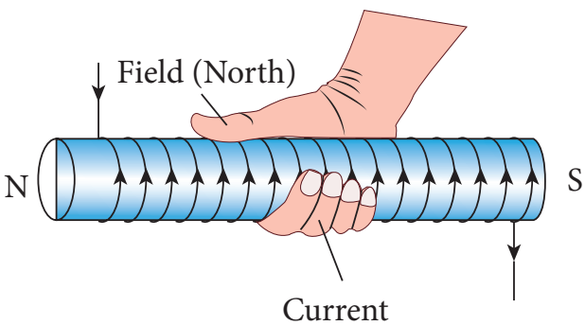


Figure 3.40 The direction of magnetic field of solenoid

Figure 3.39. Hence, the magnetic field of a solenoid looks like the magnetic field of a bar magnet.

The solenoid is assumed to be long which means that the length of the solenoid is large when compared to its diameter. The winding need not to be always circular, it can also be in other shapes. We consider here only circularly wound solenoid as shown in Figure 3.40.

3.9.3 Magnetic field due to a long current carrying solenoid

Consider a solenoid of length L having N turns. The diameter of the solenoid is assumed to be much smaller when compared to its length and the coil is wound very closely.

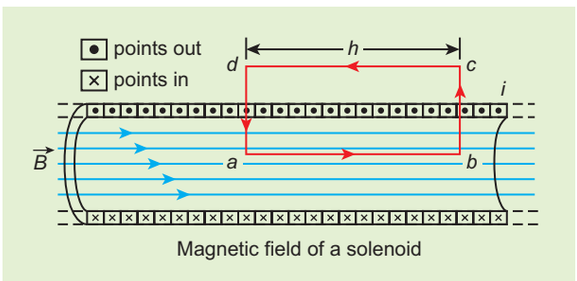


Figure 3.41 Amperian loop for solenoid

In order to calculate the magnetic field at any point inside the solenoid, we use Ampere's circuital law. Consider a rectangular loop abcd as shown in Figure 3.41. Then from Ampère's circuital law,

$$\oint_C \vec{B}\cdot d\vec{l} = \mu_\circ I_{enclosed}$$
$$= \mu_\circ \times (\text{total current enclosed by Amperian loop})$$

The left hand side of the equation is

$$\oint_C \vec{B}\cdot d\vec{l} = \int_a^b \vec{B}.d\vec{l} + \int_b^c \vec{B}.d\vec{l} + \int_c^d \vec{B}.d\vec{l} + \int_d^a \vec{B}.d\vec{l}$$

Since the elemental lengths along bc and da are perpendicular to the magnetic field

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